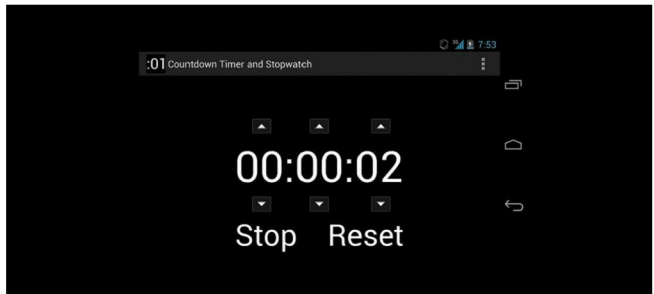


Building Manual and Automatic Counters in App Inventor 2

As this series has progressed, some readers who have been following it may have built a few apps or even a collection of them. This article guides the reader through the steps involved in building counters – both manual and automatic.



As we proceed further in making Android apps using the open source App Inventor tool, let's now introduce a little of mathematics into the application. The next project will be a manual counter; before we go on to building an automatic counter run by the internal clock of the phone, which will be handier.

Manual counter

Though mathematics is not liked by some of us, its role in our daily lives can't be ignored. Every single thing that requires keeping track of has to go through a counting process where the use of the most basic mathematics is required. We start learning mathematics via numbers and counting, so here as well, we will begin with a number game to count things. We are going to create a manual counter application, which, on the press of a button, enables you to increase the count and on the press of another button enables you to decrease the count.

GUI requirements

We will not need much by way of GUI requirements as the app is very basic. We will require two button components and a label component, along with some horizontal arrangements to keep things aligned.

We will require the following components for this project:

	Component	Purpose	Location
1	Horizontal arrangement	To arrange the child components horizontally	Palette--> Layout--> Horizontal Arrangement
2	Label	To display the value of what has been counted	Palette-->User Interface-->Label
3	Button	One button to increase the count	Palette-->User Interface-->Button
4	Button	One button to decrease the count	Palette-->User Interface-->Button

Getting started

1. Drag and drop the components mentioned above to the viewer.
2. The visible components can be seen by you while the non-visible components will be located beneath the viewer under the tag, 'Non-visible'.
3. We have placed a label so as to put the name of the application.